

1949, April 21

The following is a faithful transcription of a photocopy of the handwritten and typed original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M.Cap.

4-21-49

St. Felix Friary
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Blessed be God in all His designs!

My Dear Sister Emma:- God bless you this joyful season of Eastertide and this even though in your condition the time must seem monotonous all the better chance to give a good sermon. The very best sermon one can give: - "How?" some one may ask, or on what subject!

April 22 1949, Dear Emma: again; I am going to answer the above question by telling you of a dear class-mate of mine who was 84 last January 10th.

About six months ago his sight became so poor that he had to give up saying holy Mass entirely. We all knew it: and oucourse we knew he would not like to hear such a decision.

However, I was sort_of deligated to break the unfavorable item. I asked him: "... Well Father Damasus: How about that Sermon ?" "What sermon?" he enquired. We were all more or less anticipating indications of disapointment, etc. on his part; because not only was his sight failing seriously but his rearing likewise. I said: "Well Fr. D./its the last sermon any of us will be able to give and its on patience and holy resignation." Thanks be to God; he received the announcement without the least change of countenance and has been an esample of patience and resignation ever since - a real sermon and edification to the 30 novices and to us all. Never a complaint!

I hope Dear Sister that you will forgive me for not writing you. I hav stated a number of times to do so; but honestly more friquently there are so many things it seems I ought to do and do not get time that I feel I get no where and do seemingly nothing. I am sure Fr. Edw'd has written of Fr.E.J.'s peaceful and beautiful death and really joyful, solemn Mass and funeral. Every one seemed happy. As we followed His Excellency the Bishop from the cemetery one of the fifteen priest half-exclaiemd-"This is more like a bridal affair than a funeral." ... Keep courage; rather confidence in God, which is courage divinely reenforced.

Pl. pray for poor Fr. Solanus - yours in Christ Fraternally.

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